their quest to champion the people, they seek to diminish the international organizations (IOs) and treaties that states have gradually forged since the conclusion of World War II. Strikingly, many of the architects of the liberal international order have become its staunchest critics under populist regimes.

Global Governance Under Fire cuts to the heart of this storm, exploring the effects of populists' attacks on the foundations of the international order. The book confronts several pressing questions: Can international cooperation survive despite the rise and persistence of populism? If so, what form will it take, and what are the implications for the quality of global governance?

This book spotlights international organizations' attempts to fight back against detractors. We show that IOs are not helpless but rather have several powerful tools at their disposal that can allow them to persevere and even thrive. Yet their methods can also have unintended consequences, at times eroding their legitimacy and fueling additional populist resistance. We provide recommendations for policymakers and practitioners seeking to make their institutions more "populist-proof" while avoiding these negative side effects.

1.1 Populism and Global Governance

Scholars and policymakers often react to the spread of populism with pessimism regarding the future of global governance. They express concern that as populism surges around the globe, globalization will stagnate or reverse, and the international organizations that support it will incur significant damage. This is because, as we describe subsequently, populists are highly pro–state sovereignty and anti-elite. Because international organizations are staffed by elites and place constraints on their members, populists typically oppose them.

For example, Goldstein and Gulotty (2021, 553) observe, "Today, American commitment to the [trade] regime may be at a watershed moment, facing both anti–trade treaty populism at home and skepticism from its founders abroad." Others suggest that the World Trade Organization (WTO)—the largest and most important multilateral trade body—has incurred fatal damage: "The WTO was a lovely promise of a more rational, predictable, and fairer global economic order. Its death should be mourned."[1]